

Lecture 2: Working with Data

SOC612: Data Analytics for Social Research

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Today's schedule

- 1 **Administration:** Access, Group assignment
- 2 **Reading:** Edelman, A., Wolff, T., Montagne, D., & Bail, C. A. (2020). Computational social science and sociology. *Annual Review of Sociology*, 46(1), 61–81
- 3 **Data preparation:** Preparing survey data for further analyses in R and Python
- 4 **Outlook for next week**
- 5 **Tutorial:** *SOC612_Task1.pdf* on Moodle, GitHub

- Access to the LU Moodle and GitHub?
- Reproducible Coding Exercise and Analytical Memo: distributed on November 3, has to be handed in until November 23, and covers all the topics until November 3. Datasets will be provided. A documented script and an analytical memo (750-1,000 words) with a sociological interpretation of the results has to be submitted.
- Group Computational Project: in groups of 2 or 3, students must submit a short research project with a sociological question (1,500-2,000 words), and a reproducible script, using at least one of the methods covered in the lecture. Students can use their own datasets or a dataset used in the lecture. The submission deadline will be in mid-December, after the group presentation.

Reading

Edelmann, A., Wolff, T., Montagne, D., & Bail, C. A. (2020). Computational social science and sociology. *Annual Review of Sociology*, 46(1), 61–81

Group activity

Form groups of 2-3 students. Please work together with someone you don't know well yet and discuss the following questions in groups.

Edelmann, A., Wolff, T., Montagne, D., & Bail, C. A. (2020). Computational social science and sociology. *Annual Review of Sociology*, 46(1), 61–81

Group activity

- ① **Q1:** The authors mention 7 fields where CSS is emerging fast (p.3). For which ones do you see the greatest potential for social sciences? Where do you see some risks?
- ② **Q2:** Do you think individual or collective digital behaviour can be explained by existing social science theories from an analogue era? What are some arguments for, what against?
- ③ **Q3:** Can you think of human individual or collective behaviours that emerged only in recent years, with the rise in the latest digital technologies?

Data Preparation

- We'll go through the data preparation for a cross-sectional survey dataset.
- For this example, we're interested in attitudes towards economic activity, and science and technology in East Asia.
- We'll go through the various steps of the data preparation. Depending on the exact question or research interest, these steps might differ, and have to be extended or shortened.
- → R Markdown. On the LU moodle and GitHub, you'll also find a *.ipynb* file.

Tutorial



- Please download *SOC612_Task1.pdf* and the datasets from the SOC612 course on moodle or GitHub.
- A solution will be uploaded tomorrow morning on moodle and GitHub.

Thanks for coming!

SEE YOU
NEXT TIME